the sea, now its uncontrol able energy came as a revelation to me.

By the time the boat met its untimely end, Ahmed Jal aluddin had become a close friend of mine, despite the difference in our ages. He was about 15 years older than I and used to cal me Azad. We used to go for long walks together every evening. As we started from Mosque Street and made our way towards the sandy shores of the island, Jal aluddin and I talked mainly of spiritual matters. The atmosphere of Rameswaram, with its flocking pilgrims, was conducive to such discussion. Our first halt would be at the imposing temple of Lord Shiva. Circling around the temple with the same reverence as any pilgrim from a distant part of the country, we felt a flow of energy pass through us. Jal aluddin would talk about God as if he had a working partnership with Him. He would present al his doubts to God as if He were standing nearby to dispose of them. I would stare at Jal aluddin and then look towards the large groups of pilgrims around the temple, taking holy dips in the sea, performing rituals and reciting prayers with a sense of respect towards the same Unknown, whom we treat as the formless Almighty. I never doubted that the prayers in the